

1 More than a phone

Today mobile phones are used for pretty much anything and everything except for flushing the toilet. Deciding on which one to buy with the plethora of choices available can be as daunting a task as choosing a life partner. To aid you in that decision, in this section we will categorise the phones into various categories and elaborate on each so you can decide if your phone suits your photographer lifestyle or the clad-in-suit guy image. In the next section, we will mention a few models available in the Indian market of each category along with the estimated street price.

1.1 Camera phones

If you are the person who snaps odd road signs, weird advertisement hoardings or just someone who always wishes to capture the current moment for eternity, your mobile today can offer sufficient imaging capabilities to satisfy casual needs. Things you should look for in phones, with the primary purpose of putting a camera in your pocket are as follows:

- >3 MP resolution (preferably 5MP and above)
- Flash (preferably a Xenon flash)
- Support for external memory card
- Autofocus
- VGA recording capability at 30 FPS

You should ignore the digital zoom ratings.



Capture precious moments

Features straight from dedicated cameras such as face detection and geo-tagging are also being offered by some camera phones today.

